



Shake it, close it!

Want to minimize all windows but one, shake the phone to minimise all the background ones. Read more here: <http://dgit.in/snakeneclose>



Selfie Tips- iPhone

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Geek life

specs comparable to a high-end smart-phone. Meant as an Internet of Things platform, the ARTIK 1 is powered by a new and real time OS called Nucleus. The SDK supports C/C++ development while its elder siblings run on custom Linux distribution featuring added support for development in Java and Groovy. Don't get your hopes too high because currently the device is only available to Samsung's partners and a select few developers. It will be a while before it hits retail.

2

Modulo – The 'Lego' amongst the maker tech listed here,

Modulo aims to bridge the gap between the not-so-powerful educational electronic kits in the market and advanced maker tech. Just like Lego blocks, there are different interconnected modules, each with its own microcontroller, without the need of any bread-board or soldering. Started off as a Kickstarter project, the Northern California based startup has already raised around \$50,000, five times its original target of \$10,000, and is aptly described as "a simple, modular solution for building powerful electronic devices".

The device is not only Arduino compatible, thereby letting you expand Modulo's capabilities, but it also comes with a number of modules. The company is initially offering a colour OLED display, push-button illuminated knob, motor driver, thumb joystick and a temperature probe, with more modules promised to come. All modules can be connected to your computer through USB and can be reprogrammed using the Arduino IDE. The device, expected to be ready for shipping by November can be used to create a number of DIY projects ranging from a simple automatic light switch to more complicated ones by pairing it with Arduino or Raspberry Pi.

3

BBC Micro Bit – The Micro Bit by BBC is aimed primarily at

school students and aims to get them hooked on to programming and electronics. Developed with support from a number of tech giants including



BBC aims to deliver it to a million school children by the end of this year

Samsung, Microsoft and ARM Holdings, Micro Bit is basically an embedded software platform which will be fully compatible with Raspberry Pi. The light-weight device will sport a 5x5 LED display, motion detection, built-in compass, Bluetooth capabilities and can be attached to clothing too. The device features five input output rings that can be connected to a number of sensors and devices using crocodile clips.

It supports software development in a variety of languages including Python, C++ and Blockly. It presents kids with two options: either use a GUI code editor called the Microsoft Block editor, or the web-based TouchDevelop platform. Micro Bit is supposed to be an 'initiation device' of sorts that can be paired



The kickstarter campaign has raised \$16,000

with all the other big players in the game like Arduino, Kano and Raspberry Pi. Still in the prototype phase, BBC plans to deliver it to a million school children in the UK by late October of this year.

4

XplorerBoard – Another Kickstarter project, the XplorerBoard aims to help

students learn electronics quickly by doing things instead of just reading up about them. The Kickstarter campaign reads "for ages 8 to 80" and has crossed its target of \$10,000 on the crowdfunding website. XplorerBoard is supposed to be a 'Self-contained Arduino development environment', which comes with all necessary sensors. The device's official app comes with 50 experiments that feature detailed videos explaining each and every step alongside the required Arduino programming code.

5

SAM – Another Lego-essque device, the SAM is a complete electronics kit that consists of a

number of wireless-connection capable modules. Developed by a 23 year old mechanical engineer named Joachim Horn, SAM doesn't require prior coding knowledge. But this doesn't mean that SAM is solely aimed at curious kids. The modules can be effectively used to create a number of IoT devices.

SAM modules can be programmed using the companion app which lets you intuitively drag and drop software modules, which automatically generate the relevant code making it easier for kids. But having a drag and drop programming environment doesn't mean that SAM is just another electronic kit for kids to play with. It can be used to build a number of complicated projects including autonomous cars, talking glasses and much

more. SAM kits come in all sizes, starting with the basic kit that will cost you around \$70 and include three wireless modules. The family kit costs \$650 and comes with a number of other sophisticated modules such as temperature and light sensors for building fairly complicated projects. It's definitely worth